

xylophones, and drums.

grand opera

French development of **opera**, characterized by historical plots, large choruses, crowd scenes, ornate costumes, and spectacular sets.

intermezzo

A light-hearted interlude performed between the acts of an opera seria. The intermezzo developed from the intermedio, a short musical drama performed between the acts of spoken plays in the 15th and 16th centuries.

inversion

A **chord** or line of music is said to be inverted when its component notes have been reshuffled in a different order.

key

The **tonal** center of a piece of music, based on the first note of the **scale**.

leitmotif

Literally “leading motif” (German); a short musical phrase that recurs through a piece to indicate the presence of a character, emotion, or object.

libretto (pl. libretti)